

Comment: Bernstein SDC - Sandisk

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Demand: AI is a significant demand driver, with CY26 data center EB growth expectation repeatedly increasing from mid-20s to mid-60s and now mid-70s. NAND is becoming increasingly important for AI inference architectures as it is a highly scalable and economic. Management uses bottoms-up analysis with customers, CapEx spending trends, and continuous market discussions to gauge demand durability and future needs.

Supply: Supply growth is now driven by R&D productivity and nodal transitions. For capacity decisions - those are made years in advance, independent of short-term demand. The company can get the growth without huge amount of incremental capex.

LTA: Long-term agreements, termed "new business models," aim to reduce cyclicity and align business models with customers, moving beyond traditional agreements that only committed volume. These new business models aim to align the company's and customers' business models, ensure predictable consumption, and include incentive structures involves a third party holding funds (escrow) to ensure contract adherence, providing a "soft landing" with cash if a customer must exit. These new models require partners to consume significant product, grow demand faster than supply, and consume predictably, with customers seeking supply commitments for 2-5 years.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	28 May 2026		Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
		Cur	Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
AAPL (Apple)	O	USD	312.51	350.00	27.5%	USD	7.46	8.87	10.65	41.9	35.2	29.3
DELL (Dell)	O	USD	317.05	280.00	150.2%	USD	10.35	13.46	16.47	30.6	23.5	19.3
HPE (HPE)	M	USD	38.21	35.00	87.6%	USD	1.96	2.43	2.85	19.5	15.7	13.4
HPQ (HPQ)	M	USD	25.01	27.00	(36.5)%	USD	3.12	3.00	3.04	8.0	8.3	8.2
IBM (IBM)	M	USD	264.22	280.00	(26.9)%	USD	11.58	12.35	13.93	22.8	21.4	19.0
SNDK (SanDisk)	O	USD	1,641.64	1,700.00	4126.7%	USD	2.99	64.73	200.47	549.0	25.4	8.2
STX (Seagate)	O	USD	880.72	1,000.00	622.1%	USD	8.10	14.89	32.49	108.7	59.1	27.1
SMCI (SMCI)	M	USD	41.30	37.00	(30.0)%	USD	2.60	2.80	3.25	15.9	14.7	12.7
WDC (Western Digital)	O	USD	531.18	590.00	886.2%	USD	4.80	9.81	20.19	110.6	54.2	26.3
SPX			7,563.63									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

DELL estimate is Reported EPS; DELL, SMCI base year is 2026;

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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Underperform	SELL	12.6%	14.9%

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